

YOUR PERSONALIZED

Claude Usage Strategy

Built for your profile as a Student
focused on Research & Coding

Role: **Student**

Focus: **Research + Coding**

Usage: **Daily**

Primary Need: **Deep Analysis**



Overview



Models



Effort



Workflow



Mistakes



RECOMMENDED PRIMARY MODEL

Claude Sonnet 4.6

Your daily workhorse for research and coding

- Sonnet 4.6 is the sweet spot for a student: smart enough for deep research and complex coding, fast enough for daily use without burning through limits.
- Haiku is too lightweight for your research depth needs.
- Opus is powerful but overkill for most daily student tasks — save it for your hardest problems.



IF YOU COULD USE ONLY ONE MODEL + ONE EFFORT

Sonnet 4.6 + High Effort

As a student doing daily research and coding, **Sonnet at High effort** gives you the best ROI. It's smart enough to understand academic material and complex code, thorough enough to give you genuinely useful depth, and fast enough to use every single day without friction. You'll get 90% of Opus quality at a fraction of the cost to your usage quota — and it won't slow you down when you're on a deadline.



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Claude Haiku

Quick lookups

USE WHEN:

- ✓ Define a term or concept fast
- ✓ Summarize a short article
- ✓ Fix a tiny syntax bug
- ✓ Translate a sentence
- ✓ Quick grammar check

⚠ Avoid for anything requiring depth, nuance, or multi-step reasoning.



Claude Sonnet

Your daily workhorse

USE WHEN:

- ✓ Explain complex research concepts
- ✓ Debug and write real code
- ✓ Summarize long papers or chapters
- ✓ Draft essays or reports
- ✓ Analyze data or case studies

⚠ Rarely need to avoid — this handles 80% of your work.



Claude Opus

Your ace for hard problems

USE WHEN:

- ✓ Thesis or dissertation planning
- ✓ Deeply ambiguous research synthesis
- ✓ Complex algorithm design
- ✓ Cross-disciplinary reasoning
- ✓ Final review of critical work

⚠ Don't waste it on simple tasks — it's slower and uses more of your quota.



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Effort level tells Claude how much reasoning depth to apply. Higher effort = more thorough but slower. Match it to what the task actually needs — don't default to Max for everything.



Low Effort — Casual, quick tasks

Define a word

Reword a sentence

Simple factual question



Standard Effort — Most daily work

Study explanations

Code help

Essay drafts

Research summaries



High Effort — Demanding tasks

Research paper analysis

Complex bug fixing

Comparing multiple studies



Max Effort — Critical / high-stakes

Thesis research

Final project code architecture

Exam prep synthesis



Your Default Recommendation

Start at **Standard** for most daily tasks. Step up to **High** for research papers, debugging, and essays. Reserve **Max** for thesis-level or final-submission work.



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Task-by-Task Workflow Guide

Optimized for your student profile

TASK	BEST MODEL	EFFORT	WHY
Understand a research paper	Sonnet	High	Needs nuanced comprehension of academic language
Write / debug code	Sonnet	Standard	Strong reasoning + speed balance for coding
Quick concept definition	Haiku	Low	Simple lookup — no depth needed
Summarize lecture notes	Sonnet	Standard	Medium depth, everyday study task
Synthesize multiple papers	Opus	Max	Highest reasoning for complex cross-source analysis
Essay / report drafting	Sonnet	High	Writing quality matters; worth the extra effort
Exam prep & Q&A	Sonnet	Standard	Conversational depth without over-spending quota
Thesis / project planning	Opus	Max	High-stakes strategic reasoning deserves max power
Fix a small typo/syntax bug	Haiku	Low	Trivial task — fast response wins
Learn a new programming concept	Sonnet	High	Learning benefits from thorough, step-by-step



Workflow



Mistakes

Common mistakes students make with Claude — and how to avoid them.



Using Opus for everything

It's powerful but slow and quota-heavy. Sonnet handles 80% of your needs.



Using Haiku for deep research

It will give surface-level answers. Research needs Sonnet or Opus.



Always using Max effort

Standard effort is great for most daily tasks. Save Max for truly critical work.



Pasting giant texts without framing

Always tell Claude what you want before or after pasting content.



Not iterating

Claude works best in conversation. Follow up, push back, ask it to go deeper.



Accepting the first answer blindly

For research especially — ask Claude to cite reasoning or check assumptions.



The Golden Rule for Students

Treat Claude like a brilliant study partner, not a search engine. **Give context. Ask follow-ups. Push for depth.** The quality of your output is directly proportional to the quality of your prompts.